

# A \$1.8 Billion Fund on Hold, and Primaries to Watch

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Have you ever had your allowance put on hold? Well, the U.S. government just had a giant \$1.8 billion fund **frozen** by a court! The Trump administration wanted to use this money to help people who claim the federal government targeted them unfairly. But a lot of people from both political parties got worried. They thought the fund might end up paying folks who were convicted for storming the Capitol on January 6, 2021. So a **federal judge** said, "Hold on, not so fast." The **Justice Department** says it will follow the court's order and pause the money. Meanwhile, it's a big day for voting! Six states California, Iowa, Montana, New Jersey, South Dakota, and New Mexico are holding **primary** elections. The most exciting races are for **governor** in California and Iowa. In California, the top two candidates, no matter their party, will face off in November. Democrats hope these primaries will give them a path to win control of Congress later this year. In other news, President Trump says Israel and Hezbollah agreed to stop fighting for a bit, but Iran isn't happy and paused peace talks. And tennis superstar Serena Williams is coming out of retirement to play **doubles** in London the tournament called her "THE QUEEN."

## Word Treasure

**frozen** -- When a court freezes a fund, it means the money cannot be spent or moved until a judge gives permission.

**federal judge** -- A federal judge is a judge who works in a U.S. federal court and makes decisions about national laws.

**Justice Department** -- The Justice Department is part of the U.S. government that enforces the law and handles legal matters for the country.

**primary** -- A primary is an early election where voters pick the strongest candidates to run in the final election.

**governor** -- A governor is the elected leader of a state, like the president of that state.

**doubles** -- In tennis, doubles is a match where two players play on each side of the net instead of one.

## Background you need

On January 6, 2021, a group of people who supported Donald Trump broke into the U.S. Capitol building in Washington, D.C., an event that led to many arrests and trials.

Serena Williams is one of the greatest tennis players ever, having won 23 major singles titles and inspired millions with her power and determination.

Hezbollah is a militant group based in Lebanon that has fought several wars with Israel, while Iran is a large country in the Middle East that often opposes the United States and Israel.

## Break it down

**WHO:** The Trump administration, a federal judge, the Justice Department, and voters in six states

**WHAT:** A \$1.8 billion government fund was frozen by a court because of fears it could benefit January 6 defendants; meanwhile, primaries are happening

**WHERE:** In the United States, with key governor races in California and Iowa

**WHY:** The freeze happened because many people from both parties worried the fund could be misused, and the primaries are part of the regular election cycle

## Why it matters

Big decisions about money and elections show how our government checks itself, and what happens in these primaries can affect laws about schools, safety, and parks where you play.

## Test what you remember

1. What happened to the \$1.8 billion fund?
  - (A) It was given to storm victims
  - (B) A federal judge froze it
  - (C) It was sent to Congress
  - (D) It was used to pay for the Capitol
2. Why did some people worry about the fund?
  - (A) It might help people convicted for storming the Capitol on January 6
  - (B) It was too small to help anyone
  - (C) It would only go to Democrats
  - (D) It came from a foreign country
3. Which states are holding primary elections, according to the article?
  - (A) California, Iowa, Montana, New Jersey, South Dakota, and New Mexico
  - (B) Texas, Florida, and New York
  - (C) Only California and Iowa
  - (D) All 50 states
4. What is Serena Williams going to do?
  - (A) Run for office
  - (B) Play doubles tennis in London
  - (C) Coach a soccer team
  - (D) Write a book
5. Who paused peace talks after Israel and Hezbollah agreed to stop fighting?
  - (A) The United Nations
  - (B) Iran
  - (C) President Trump
  - (D) California
6. What is the next step for the frozen fund, according to the article?
  - (A) The Justice Department will obey the court order and pause the money
  - (B) The money will be burned
  - (C) The fund will be given to California
  - (D) It will be used immediately for the Capitol

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: B 2: A 3: A 4: B 5: B 6: A

## Questions to think about

- 1. Administration view (positive):** The fund was meant to help Americans who felt unfairly targeted by the federal government, which some see as a way to right past wrongs.
- 2. Watchdogs and critics (negative):** Many are concerned the money could go to people who broke the law on January 6, which they believe would be wrong and disrespectful to the rule of law.
- 3. Judicial system view (neutral):** The court's order is an example of how the judicial branch can step in and pause executive actions when there are serious questions about their fairness.

**MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):**